



ED 452C: Instructional Strategies for Inclusive Classrooms C Summer A 2026, May 18th-June 26th

Instructor Information

Instructor: Elyse Schirmer

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Office Hours: Please contact me for a zoom appointment.

Course Information

Dates of Course: online synchronous T/Th 3:40-4:40PM

Zoom Meeting URL:

<https://us05web.zoom.us/j/2116412181?pwd=WVJBMEtRR1VuREkveGRUMmQrUzJxdz09>

Required Textbook:

Wehmeyer, M. L., & Kurth, J. A. (2021). *Inclusive education in a strengths-based era: Mapping the future of the field*. W. W. Norton & Company.

Recommended Textbook:

American Psychological Association (2019). *Publication manual* (7th ed.) APA.

Program: Teaching and Curriculum

Credits Allocated: 1

Prerequisites: ED 452A and ED 452B

Course Description:

Building on what is learned in ED 451, this course further explores and develops appropriate teaching and learning strategies to support all types of students in the classroom. Examines evidence-based instructional practices to understand how people learn and examines differentiated instruction through, among others, the concept of multiple intelligences and strength-based assessment and instruction. Assists teachers in identifying systemic structures that impede student learning and developing advocacy skills to break down these barriers. ED 452C covers classroom management, collaboration with related services professionals and families, assistive technology, and transitions. (Meets content-pedagogy requirement for professional teaching certification).

Course Learning Objectives:

These objectives remain consistent across each of the three parts to the ED452 series and they will build upon each other throughout. The readings, activities, and assessments throughout this course integrate the Council for Exceptional Children (CEC) professional preparation standards. With these standards considered, by the end of this course students will...

- Experience and reflect upon the complexities of working as part of an educational team consisting of teachers, support service providers, administrators to meet the educational needs of all children and identify the many ways in which teachers, parents, and related and community-based services work collaboratively to meet the academic, behavior and

social needs of children. (CEC 2, 5, 7)

- Examine the variations in beliefs, traditions and values across cultures within society, the effects of the relationships among child, family, and schooling, and articulate the factors that influence the overrepresentation of culturally/linguistically diverse students in programs for individuals with disabilities. (CEC 1, 2)
- Use research-based methods of designing optimal multi-sensory, student initiated, interactive learning environments for instructing all students, including those with disabilities, across a variety of learning environments. (CEC 2, 4, 5, 6)
- Understand the various disabling conditions, and the impact of social skills on the lives of individuals with disabilities and the effects of dysfunctional behavior on learning. (CEC 1, 2)
- Implement alternative approaches to create positive, strategic learning environments for all individuals, including those with various levels and severity of disabilities. (CEC 1, 2, 5)
- Demonstrate an understanding of the importance of collaboration with classroom teachers and other school and community personnel in integrating individuals with exceptional learning needs into various learning environments and the coordination of activities of related services personnel to maximize instruction time for individuals with disabilities. (CEC 2, 5, 7)
- Design an instructional program that addresses instruction in independent living skills and exploration of career / postsecondary education for students with disabilities, including those who do not use reliable speech, emphasizing positive self-concepts, realistic goals, and self- management procedures. (CEC 1, 2, 4, 5)
- Demonstrate an understanding of research-based instructional strategies and practices, including embedded functional skills approaches, community-based instruction, task analysis, the integration of related services, adaptive skills in academic and nonacademic areas for all students, including those with disabilities. (CEC 4, 5, 6)
- Develop problem solving, strategic thinking skills and test taking strategies to enhance thinking processes to promote successful transitions and to meet individual student needs across a variety of learning environments. (CEC 1, 2, 4, 5)
- Evaluate, select, and develop curriculum materials and technology appropriate for individuals with disabilities; modify and adapt curriculum, instruction, and assessment using sources of specialized materials for individuals with disabilities as needed. (CEC 1, 2, 3, 4, 5)
- Identify the impact of disabilities on auditory skills, language development, and examine the relationship between disabilities and literacy instruction. (CEC 1, 2, 4)
- Integrate academic instruction, effective education, and research-based behavior management for individual learners and classroom management for groups of learners by providing a safe, supportive learning environment where diversity is valued. (CEC 1, 2, 5, 7)
- Integrate social skills needed for educational and functional living environments and effective instruction into the curriculum by increasing individuals' self-awareness, self-control, self-reliance and self-esteem. (CEC 2, 5)
- Demonstrate an understanding of how to design, structure, and manage daily routines, effectively including transition time, for students, support staff, volunteers, and the instructional setting. (CEC 2, 5, 7)
- Modify and adapt curriculum, instruction, and assessment by sequencing, implementing,

and evaluating individual learning objectives and involving the individual and family in setting instructional goals and charting progress. (CEC 1, 3, 4, 5)

- Develop individualized assessment strategies for instruction, methods of monitoring progress of individuals with exceptional learning needs, and use assessment information in making instructional decisions and planning individual programs that result in appropriate placement and intervention for all individuals with exceptional learning needs, including those from culturally and/or linguistically diverse backgrounds. (CEC 1, 4, 6)
- Demonstrate an understanding of the importance of working with families to support students in their academic and social growth, involve the individual and family in exploring career, vocational, residential, and transition programs, understand the importance of life skill instruction relative to independent, community, personal living and employment, and the use of collaborative strategies in working with individuals with exceptional learning needs, parents, and school and community personnel in these various learning environments. (CEC 6, 7)
- Demonstrate proficiency in oral written communication. (CEC 2, 6)
- Demonstrate commitment to developing the highest educational and quality of life potential of individuals with exceptional learning needs. (CEC 6)
- Demonstrate an understanding of the importance of the teacher's serving as a model for individuals with exceptional learning needs. (CEC 1, 6)

Course Expectations

Classroom Community:

The Warner Graduate School of Education and Human Development is dedicated to fostering a learning community that represents and builds on the rich diversity of human experiences, backgrounds, cultures, histories, ideas, and ways of living. Consistent with our dedication to education, leadership, counseling, and human development that can transform lives and make the world more just and humane, we recruit, support and learn with and from students, staff, and faculty from the broadest spectrum of human diversity. Likewise, we seek the same through our interactions with the broader local and global community. See the following link for the Warner School's statement: (<https://www.warner.rochester.edu/about/diversity>). See <https://www.rochester.edu/diversity/policies/> for the University of Rochester's statements about diversity.

Written Assignments:

All assignments are to be submitted in a word document or Google Doc through Blackboard, following the American Psychological Association (APA) Publication Manual, *7th Edition*.

Late Assignments:

Please contact me with regards to due date accommodations in advance of the due date. Without prior approval, late assignments will be marked 10% per class meeting until it is turned in.

Academic Policies

Accessibility and Accommodations:

The University of Rochester respects and welcomes students of all backgrounds and abilities. In the event you encounter any barrier(s) to full participation in this course due to the impact of a

disability, please contact the Office of Disability Resources. The access coordinators in the Office of Disability Resources can meet with you to discuss the barriers you are experiencing and explain the eligibility process for establishing academic accommodations. You can reach the Office of Disability Resources at: disability@rochester.edu; (585) 276-5075; Taylor Hall. You may also contact Mary Judge Diegert, Warner's Disability Resource Coordinator at mjudge@warner.rochester.edu (585) 273-1838; LeChase Hall 470.

Online Etiquette, Anti-Discrimination and Harassment Policy:

The University strictly prohibits the use of University online resources or facilities, including Blackboard, for the purpose of harassment of any individual or for the posting of any material that is scandalous, libelous, offensive or otherwise against the University's policies. Please see: <https://www.rochester.edu/policies/policy/discrimination-harassment/> and report an issue to the Office of Equity and Inclusion at uofr.us/padh-report.

Title IX:

All members of the University community have the right to learn and work in a safe environment free from all forms of harassment, including harassment on the basis of sex or gender. Students who have been subjected to sexual harassment, including sexual assault, dating/domestic violence or stalking, have the right to receive academic, housing, transportation or other accommodations, to receive counseling and health services and to make a report about such behavior to the University and to law enforcement. For more information, please visit <http://www.rochester.edu/sexualmisconduct> or contact Professor Carol St. George, Deputy Title IX Coordinator; cstgeorge@warner.rochester.edu (585) 275-0967; LeChase Hall 454.

Academic Integrity:

Academic dishonesty is unacceptable and will not be tolerated. Cheating, forgery, plagiarism and collusion in dishonest acts undermine the educational mission of the University of Rochester and the students' personal and intellectual growth. Please see the Regulations and University Policies Concerning Graduate Studies handbook:

<https://www.rochester.edu/GradBulletin/PDFbulletin/Regulations.pdf>

UR Care Services:

The CARE Network enables members of the University community to express their concern about a person, incident, or issue. If you are concerned about another student or yourself, please visit UR Care Network to make a referral: <https://www.rochester.edu/care/>. The University Counseling Center is also available for appointments and consultation for all U of R students (585) 275-3113.

Additional Warner Policies and Forms can be found at

<https://www.warner.rochester.edu/policies-forms>.

Allowable Uses of AI:

Consistent with UR guidelines for the use of AI in education, at Warner we recognize that AI could provide valuable tools for you as a student - provided that you use AI in ways that assist/enhance rather than replace learning, you verify the accuracy and appropriateness of AI-generated products, and you meet UR policies about data privacy and confidentiality. We also believe it is our responsibility to prepare future educators who can use AI effectively, safely and

ethically in their work, and that can empower their students to do the same. This needs to start with ensuring that AI is used in appropriate ways by Warner students in all our courses, while also recognizing that what constitutes appropriate use will depend on the specific tasks students are asked to perform - and most importantly, the learning goals of each task. Therefore, each course instructor is expected to determine when and how AI can be used in their course, and to make this expectation explicit to students.

In this course, given its scope and learning goals, students are welcomed to use AI tools to support their learning and completion of course assignments UNLESS explicitly prohibited by the instructor for a specific task. We expect students to use their judgement to ensure that their chosen use of AI supports rather than replaces/reduces their learning, and also ask that students disclose their use of AI in specific assignments, briefly describing how AI was used.

Assignments & Assessments

Class Participation (5% of overall grade):

You are expected to attend all scheduled classes. It is also expected that you will contact me if an absence is anticipated in order to make arrangements. You need to attend each class fully prepared by keeping up with the readings in order to participate in all class activities.

Discussion Posts (10% of overall grade): Due the day before each class

You will respond to the assigned reading with one comment or question as a discussion post, which is due on Blackboard at 11:59PM the day before that class session.

Learning Assistant Lesson (10% of overall grade):

You will be the “Learning Assistant” for one class session, meaning you will be the instructor for the lesson. You may create a presentation of the course material for that week, or lead the class with activities in any way you see fit. This will be guided, I will be a resource for you to bounce ideas off of or even review your material previous to the course if you so choose. Depending on the size of the class, you may need to collaborate with classmates for the same class session.

Indicator 13 Checklist Review (25% of overall grade): Due 6/16/2026

You will use a copy of a student’s IEP who is 15 or older (please obtain permission with teacher/family). If you cannot access one, please contact me. Use the Indicator 13 Checklist Template, found on Blackboard, to review the information in the IEP.

Discuss in a reflection (a) what was present, (b) the quality of the information that was present (using readings and course knowledge to evaluate), and (c) additional information that you would consider as important. In what ways do you feel that the transition section is designed appropriately to meet this student’s goals and objectives? Please refer to the rubric on Blackboard. You will submit your review in Blackboard as a word document by the due date.

Journal Article Review (25% of overall grade): Due by 6/23/2026

Using the library databases, find an educational journal article on Social-Emotional Learning (SEL) or Positive Behavior Intervention and Supports (PBIS). Read the article and then write a one-page reflection. In your reflection, you need to state the title of the article, the authors, and the journal it came from (cite the article in APA). Your reflection needs to include a summary of the key information from the article as well as what you learned from the reading. Please refer to

the rubric on Blackboard. You will submit your article in Blackboard, and it can be turned in at any point during the course by the due date. Here is the link to the Rush Rhees Library Database: <https://www.library.rochester.edu/spaces/rush-rhees>

Reflection (25% of overall grade): Due 6/25/2026

Personal and professional reflection are key components of the learning process. For this assignment, you will write a two to three-page reflection on what you have gained from taking this course. Please refer to the rubric on Blackboard. You will submit your reflection in Blackboard as a word document by the due date. You should guide your paper around the following questions:

- What topics in this course do you feel you had a good understanding of?
- What topics do you want to learn more about?
- How are you going to pursue further learning?

Course Grading Criteria: 100 Total Points

Warner Final Course Grades:

A (96-100%), A- (91-95%), B+ (88-90%), B (84-87%), B- (81-83%), C (71-80%), F ≤ 70%

Schedule

Dates and Topics	Readings	Assignments
Session 1: Zoom 5/19 (T) Learners' Objectives	● Syllabus	● Discussion Post
Session 2: Zoom 5/21 (Th) What is Special Education Today?	● Wehmeyer & Kurth (2021) p. 1-6	● Discussion Post
Session 3: Zoom 5/26 (T) Least Restrictive Environment	● Wehmeyer & Kurth (2021) p. 7-14	● Discussion Post
Session 4: Zoom 5/28 (Th) Strengths-Based Approaches to Disability	● Wehmeyer & Kurth (2021) p. 15-26	● Discussion Post
Session 5: Zoom 6/2 (T) Effective Practices	● Wehmeyer & Kurth (2021) p. 27-40	● Discussion Post
Session 6: Zoom 6/4 (Th) Effective Practices Continued	● Wehmeyer & Kurth (2021) p. 41-46	● Discussion Post
Session 7: Zoom 6/9 (T) Evidence in Support of Inclusive Education	● Wehmeyer & Kurth (2021) p. 47-56	● Discussion Post
Session 8: Zoom 6/11 (Th)	● NSTTAC Indicator 13	● Discussion Post

Transition	Checklist	
Session 9: Zoom 6/16 (T) Transition Continued	● Skim read OSERS Guide to Transition	● Discussion Post ● Indicator 13 Checklist Review
Session 10: Zoom 6/18 (Th) Self-Determination and Transition	● Self-Determination: Getting Students Involved in Leadership (Wehmyer & Shogren, 2013)	● Discussion Post
Session 11: Zoom 6/23 (T) SEL and PBIS	● Explore www.casel.org ● Explore www.pbis.org	● Discussion Post ● Journal Article Review (can submit anytime by 6/23)
Session 12: Zoom 6/25 (Th) Where Do We Go From Here?	● Wehmeyer & Kurth (2021) p. 57-69	● Discussion Post ● Reflection